PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Manufacturing, Supply Chain & Product Development Manager | Edge AI Program Lead
Milo Enterprises Inc., Vancouver, BC | Nov 2025 – Jun 2026

- Led an Edge AI-enabled IoT device program from concept through high-level design within approximately six months, defining system architecture and chipset strategy, coordinating outsourced AI development, and driving embedded proof-of-concept (PoC) validation, while supporting SR&ED, NRC IRAP, and BDC funding initiatives.
- Conducted four SR&ED technical experiments and completed AI model development Milestones 1 and 2 with an external engineer, covering Edge AI dataset preparation, baseline model training, model export, and embedded PoC validation against design targets (small objects moving at ~0.5 m/s; visual features ~0.50 ± 0.08 mm × 0.35 ± 0.07 mm) under noise, motion blur, variable lighting, and power, memory, cost, and processing constraints; also completed a patent feasibility assessment.
- Supported quality, manufacturability, and production improvements for existing products.

Director | Product Strategy, Digital Product Development & Operations | P&L
Woods Global Ltd., Hong Kong | Apr 2021 – Apr 2025

- Led mobile application and e-commerce development and operations, coordinating Engineering, Operations, QA, Sales, Marketing, Finance, vendors, and manufacturers across digital solutions and regional consumer-product distribution.
- Managed inventory, order fulfilment, logistics, customer service, returns/RMA, and vendor coordination across Hong Kong and other Asian markets.
- Provided technology leadership for a PolyU Micro Fund-supported AI-enabled Try-On 3D e-commerce platform, recognized as a top-performing project among ~200 teams; led a multidisciplinary team including a PhD-qualified AI/ML Chief Engineer and mentored four final-year STEM undergraduates and an MSc student through product development and commercialization.

Director | Product Development, Manufacturing & Supply Chain | P&L
Dale (HK) Limited, Hong Kong | 2004 – 2019

- Served as Business Leader in building and scaling a new ODM/OEM business, integrating Sales, Engineering, Manufacturing, Supply Chain, Finance, Quality, and strategic partners.
- Led ODM/OEM product development, contract manufacturing, operations, and P&L, delivering products from concept through NPI and mass production. Coordinated with EMS factories on Walmart EHS, retailer, and compliance audits.
- Commercialized a Philips RF chip-on board best value smallest DVB-T receiver platform within six months, delivering OEM/ODM programs for Bang & Olufsen, METRONIC (HF Group), SM/Skymaster (Thomson Group), Carrefour, Tesco, and ASDA/Walmart.
- Improved manufacturing throughput by 10%+, achieved ~95% on-time delivery, and reduced production lead times from 60+ to ~30 days.
- Identified waste and production bottlenecks and improved BGA IC SMT/PCBA repair processes, strengthening manufacturing efficiency, continuous improvement, and zero-defect quality practices for Bang & Olufsen programs.
- Established strategic supplier and manufacturing partnerships with listed companies across China and Taiwan, including TCL, DXG, and Seastar, balancing new-chipset wafer supply, lead-time and MOQ constraints, inventory exposure, total costs and commercial risks through a US$600K+ semiconductor procurement commitment, rebates, and phased deliveries to maintain OTD.
- Defined chipset strategy, selecting Philips Semiconductors as the primary platform while evaluating alternatives for performance, cost, and supply continuity.
- Recovered a one-year-delayed Timely ODM program to first shipment within three months, resolving several million HKD in excess inventory and accelerating the manufacturing partner’s first notebook OEM program by two months.

Vice President | Product Development, Manufacturing & Supply Chain | Marketing & Project Management
Pine Technology Holdings Ltd. / Moosik Ltd., Hong Kong-listed; 2,000+ manufacturing workforce | 2001 – 2004

- Promoted to IA BU Team Lead within ~6 months during business turnaround; transferred to Pine spin-off Moosik as Vice President and shareholder to support restructuring.
- Managed product categories across BUs in Korea, the US, Canada, Asia, and Europe, spanning distribution, supply chain, budgeting, and OEM operations.

- Managed the Korea R&D closure and project transfer, assuming responsibilities across Business, Purchasing, Production Planning & Material Control (PMC), Logistics, and RMA; resolved cross-functional conflicts and drove QCD, KPI, TQM, and continuous-improvement initiatives.
- Recovered the cancelled Samsung ODM program within three months during organizational restructuring by resolving technical, cross-functional, and cross-regional challenges, aligning customer and market requirements, and improving product reliability; delivered 100,000+ units to Creative within one year while supporting business-model transformation.
- Led OEM consumer electronics programs at Moosik from concept through engineering, NPI, and launch, including a Lenovo program exceeding 100,000 units within one year.
- Reduced ERP inventory from US$24.5M to US$20.7M by approximately US$3.9M (15.7%) within the first year.
- Reduced R&D costs by 85% (US$3.0M to US$0.45M) within two years through ODM-to-OEM transformation, design standardization, and supplier collaboration.
- Managed platform and chipset strategies, evaluating Texas Instruments, Cirrus Logic, and Sigmatel DSPs for performance, cost, and differentiation, while managing Samsung NAND Flash supply continuity amid supply constraints and price volatility.

Sales & Marketing Manager | New Product & Program Lead
Ngai Lik Industrial Holdings Ltd. / Denca Ltd., Hong Kong-listed; 15,000+ manufacturing workforce | 1999 – 2001

- Recruited to support business scale-up and new business development, promoted to Sales & Marketing Manager within approximately six months, then transferred to Ngai Lik Holdings headquarters as New Product & Program Lead, leading and coaching six Assistant Sales Managers.
- Supported business continuity, leadership transition, and restructuring following the departures of the Group CEO and Denca Director, coordinating across Management, Business, Engineering, and Manufacturing.
- Contributed to **27.3% revenue growth (~US$81M), 30.3% gross profit growth, and 31.1% net profit growth** over approximately 18 months through market development, commercial strategy, and cross-company integration.
- Led the VCD/audio-to-DVD transition across portfolio and chipset strategy, product development, commercialization, and production ramp-up, delivering 500,000+ DVD players within approximately 18 months and working with C-CUBE, ESS, Sony, and DVS.
- Worked with supplier and in-house engineers and manufacturing teams on DVD pilot-run testing, technical issue resolution, burn-in reliability testing, production readiness, and pre-sales sample shipments through mass-production ramp-up.
- Shipped the first >3,000-unit mass-production order within approximately three months after DVS technology became production-ready, for Skymaster.
- Developed recurring 100,000-unit OEM/ODM orders for Philco/Lafayette, Best Price, SM/Skymaster, and other customers, and led a proposed 300,000-unit Toshiba OEM program.
- Protected program continuity during a parts shortage through complex negotiation and problem-solving, securing 50,000 DVD mechanisms from a listed-company competitor while managing US$12M+ in receivables, L/C, delayed-shipment and inventory risks, rapidly increasing orders, component forecasting and supply commitments, price erosion, and constrained production capacity.
- Demonstrated integrity by declining benefits linked to discount requests on delayed shipments, and declining a separate referral-fee request involving US$18M+ in shipments; reported both matters to management and subsequently resigned for family reasons following discussions with management and a former Director.

Manager – Project Engineering & OEM Programs
Wai Kai Electronics Ltd., Hong Kong | 1996 – 1999

- Recruited by a former Hi-Tech colleague and promoted to Operations & Marketing Manager within approximately six months, supporting organizational growth across Engineering, Purchasing, Shipping, and Production as the production workforce expanded from 500 to 1,200+ employees.
- Led integration supporting the transition from audio distribution to OEM consumer electronics manufacturing, contributing to ~25% annual sales growth in a newly established subsidiary.
- Directed OEM programs for Tiger Electronics/Hasbro, Lenoxx, and other brands from concept to shipment, achieving major launches within ~6 months and 100,000+ units per major program. Coordinated manufacturing compliance and ISO audits.
- Led SANYO and DAEWOO OEM development with a limited OEM track record, resolving MPEG module supply and firmware issues involving SANYO mechanisms, Panasonic, and its distributor.
- Managed end-to-end OEM operations across clients and their engineering teams, budgeting, sourcing & procurement, suppliers, production, quality, shipping, compliance, reliability, and cost control.
- Pursued continuous improvement through MSc Electronic Engineering coursework and LLC accounting studies while working full-time; final project not completed due to work demands.

Electronic Engineer | Product Engineering, Manufacturing & DFM
Philips Hong Kong Limited (Sound & Vision) | 1995 – 1996

- Supported cross-functional DFM and R&D-to-manufacturing product transfer, covering PCB design and tooling modifications, BOM/ECN, SMT, and assembly.
- Improved reliability, product cost, quality, yield, and PPM defect performance through preventive quality control, reduced assembly time and waste, and defect reduction across engineering validation, pilot run, and mass-production ramp-up (EVT/DVT/PVT-equivalent stages).

R&D Electronic Engineer
Hi-Tech Precision Products Ltd. (Member of The Grande Holdings Group, Hong Kong-listed; 2,500+ CD-player manufacturing workforce) | 1994 – 1995

- Selected as Designer & Project Coordinator under a Japanese Chief Engineer for three Sony & Sansui OEM transfers, covering product development, UI/firmware localization and launches across 5+ countries; completed the first program approximately three months ahead of plan.
- Redesigned a CD player's main, panel, and power boards for a lower-cost mechanism and new driver chipset.
- Resigned after project completion and the departure of the Chief Engineer, following discussions with management.

EDUCATION

- Master of Business Administration (MBA) - Hong Kong Polytechnic University (**GPA 3.23/4.00,** first-year scholarship recipient)
- B.Eng. (Hons.) Electronic & Electrical Engineering - University of Leeds, United Kingdom (**WES GPA 3.67/4.00**)
  (Major in Electronics and Communication Engineering)
- Postgraduate Diploma in Electronic Engineering - Hong Kong Polytechnic University
  (Major in Electronics and Communication Engineering; MSc coursework completed; final report incomplete)

PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

- ASCM CPIM – Certified in Planning and Inventory Management
- Lean Six Sigma Black Belt

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- PMI PMP Exam Preparation — Target: Q4 2026
- CET (Electronic Engineering Technology) - Preparing

PORTFOLIO WEBSITE: *https://francistai.github.io/*
Supporting evidence for selected career achievements and CV claims, including business transformation, operational results, project records, business cases, and senior executive references. Public Appendix presents selected examples; additional supporting records and reference letters are available upon request.